

Profile

Personal information

Name	Toyota, Ian Mwai
Share different name	No
Birthdate	12/02/2004

Contact details

Email, Phone	mwaitoyota@gmail.com, +254.0718345781, Mobile, +254.0111602736, Mobile
Permanent address	Busia, 553 BUSIA, Busia, 50400, KEN
Alternate address	Thika Super highway 43844 NAIROBI, Kiambu, 00100, KEN (08/01/2022 - 10/01/2023)

Demographics

Gender Identity	Male
Sex	Male
Pronouns	He/Him
Military status	None
Hispanic or Latino/a/x	No
Race	Black or African American (Africa)

Language

English	First Language, Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
Swahili	Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
Other, Luhya	Speak, Write

Geography and nationality

Citizenship status	Citizen of non-U.S. country
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Birthplace	Bungoma, Kenya 0 years US
Other citizenships	Kenya
Current US Visa	None
Intended US Visa	F-1 Student

Common App fee waiver

Fee waiver requested	Yes, Signed: IAN MWAI TOYOTA
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Family

Household

Parents	Never Married
Home	Both Parents

Parent 1

Father

Name	Mr. CLEOPHAS W TOYOTA ()
Email, Phone	cleophas467@gmail.com, +254.0714071600, Mobile
Occupation	Other, Agricultural Officer, Unemployed
Education	Graduated from high/secondary school (or equivalent)

Parent 2

Mother

Name	Mrs. Dorcas N Murage
Email, Phone	njerid80@gmail.com, +254.0712512578, Mobile
Occupation	Other, Tailor, Self-Employed
Education	Completed grade/primary school

Siblings

Owen Toyota, Age 17
Brian Toyota, Age 15

Education

Current or most recent secondary school

Kakamega High School, Kakamega, Western, Kenya, Public (01/2018 - 04/2022)

Boarding school	Yes: Living at school
Progression	Did or will take gap year
Graduation Date	04/2022

Colleges & universities

Grades

Rank	1 / 481, Unweighted
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Current or most recent year courses

First trimester	Second trimester	Third trimester
MATH - Math - (REG)	MATH - Math - (REG)	MATH - Math - (REG)
ENG - English - (REG)	ENG - English - (REG)	ENG - English - (REG)
CHEM - Chemistry - (REG)	CHEM - Chemistry - (REG)	CHEM - Chemistry - (REG)
BIOL - Biology - (REG)	BIOL - Biology - (REG)	BIOL - Biology - (REG)
PHYS - Physics - (REG)	PHYS - Physics - (REG)	PHYS - Physics - (REG)
OTH/ELE - Business studies - (REG)	OTH/ELE - Business studies - (REG)	OTH/ELE - Business studies - (REG)
OTH/ELE - Geography - (REG)	OTH/ELE - Geography - (REG)	OTH/ELE - Geography - (REG)
OTH/ELE - Kiswahili - (REG)	OTH/ELE - Kiswahili - (REG)	OTH/ELE - Kiswahili - (REG)

Honors

Position 7 out of 831,026 students, KCSE national examination	National	12
Position 1 in the whole province out of the possible 200,000 students; KCSE 2021	State/Regional	12

3rd Best Student in KAPEK math contest	State/Regional	12
First student to appear in the top ten nationwide KCSE at Kakamega school since 1932.	School	12
Best student leader Kakamega School	School	11, 12

Community-based organizations

CBO 1	Equity College Counselling Program
Counselor	Dr. Beverly Kufwafwa
Email, Phone	beverly.kufwafwa@equitybank.co.ke, +254.0763105050

Future plans

Computer programmer or analyst, Doctorate

Testing

Leaving Exams

Mathematics	A	03/2022, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
English	A	03/2022, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
Kiswahili	A	03/2022, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
Chemistry	A	03/2022, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
Biology	A	03/2022, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
Physics	B+	04/2022, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
Geography	A	04/2022, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
Business studies	A	04/2022, Actual, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)

Activities

Student Govt./Politics

11, 12 School 20 hr/wk, 36 wk/yr Continue	Academics Captain. , Student governing Council made schedules, served as a peer mentor, facilitated group discussions, started remedial classes, and made sure the schedule was followed.
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Other Club/Activity

12 Break 2 hr/wk, 8 wk/yr Continue	Mentorship head., Personal mentorship went to several schools, advised, encouraged, inspired, shared experiences with, and prayed with pre-candidates
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Internship

PG Break 56 hr/wk, 12 wk/yr Continue	Marketing agent, accounts opening officer, Equity Bank Busia Branch opened accounts, carded elderly clients, increased clientele, and improved sales.
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Computer/Technology

10, 11, 12, PG Break 4 hr/wk, 3 wk/yr Continue	Computer training classes , Great rift computer school studied, practised, assisted friends in using their school portals, and imparted computer basics to them.
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Community Service (Volunteer)

9, 10, 11, 12 School 9 hr/wk, 2 wk/yr	Went to children home, Albertos Children's home we gave food, played with the kids, encouraged them, washed their clothing, taught them to read and write, and prayed for them.
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Career Oriented

9, 10, 11, 12 Break 1 hr/wk, 3 wk/yr Continue	Learned how to use a simple sewing machine, Mama Twins Tailoring shop I acquired knowledge, followed instructions while trimming clothing, fixed a bobbin, trained my younger brother, and repaired ripped clothes.
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Other Club/Activity

PG Break 6 hr/wk, 12 wk/yr Continue	Treasurer and co founder hen rearing club, Young innovators farmers club Co-founded, oversaw debt management, coordinated financial meetings, prepared financial documentation, and maintained consistent monthly contributions
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Other Club/Activity

11 Break 9 hr/wk, 3 wk/yr Continue	Created a temporary irrigation system for our farm, Home based initiated, supervised, and assisted with the procurement of the system's necessary equipment.
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Athletics: Club

10 School 5 hr/wk, 15 wk/yr Continue	Football, Player, Kakamega school 4W football club I participated in the 4W football club as a defender and functioned as captain, assistant coach, and cheerleader. triumphed in inter class competition
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Environmental

10 Break 1 hr/wk, 38 wk/yr Continue	Supervisor , Young planters association I planted, transplanted, watered, and weeded 100 trees. earned appreciation from the area chief
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Writing

Personal essay

Some students have a background, identity, interest, or talent that is so meaningful they believe their application would be incomplete without it. If this sounds like you, then please share your story.

"Inyuha wasee visee vyachile! Yaani msikona? Hulachelewa mmukunda. (Wake-up time is gone! Are you still asleep? We will get to the farm late.)," My father's booming voice woke me up that morning. Working my eyes up, I slipped out of bed and drew the curtains of the little window in the muddy hut I slept in. The light had already gotten in through the apertures in the wall but drawing the curtains made the sun's beams flood the room. The sun was rising, the beauty depicted in the horizon breathtaking, birds were chirruping happily, and the smell of tea spilled over fire eminent in the serene environment, the place I call home. I felt like watching more, but I had to prepare for the farm. Breakfast is a privilege at home, not a necessity. When going to the farm, we usually don't have the luxury of time to prepare it anyway. Consequently, we skipped breakfast.

The six kilometers journey began. Hoes hung on the shoulder; a tin with githeri (mixture of maize and beans) to serve as lunch on the other hand. The sun was already scorching hot when we got near the farm. The journey was becoming intolerable, but we pressed on; the farm produce was the only source of food we depended on after our father; initially, an agricultural officer was retrenched due to the devastating effect of Covid 19.

We had been away from the farm for a month as the distance did not allow us to visit the farm often. The first sight we saw when we approached the farm was tragic! The maize and bean crops were drooping, nearly drying. It had been long since the rains fell, but this was not the sight we expected! We had laid down pipes from the nearest river to irrigate the crop. The river was higher than our farm, which was in a floodplain, and water should have naturally moved down into the farm by gravity.

We found out that the hose pipes were clogged; the heavy downpour a week after we laid the lines had caused erosion, and the silt clogged the pipes. The levees formed on the river bank had rendered the water movement ineffective. The constant stream of water to the farm had been cut. We watched helplessly as the fierce sun quickly dried the last few drops of water, and the pipes dried!

Depression could be spelled from the face of everyone. Desperation had set in. Losing the crop would mean losing all my father's savings. Would mom's meager earnings be able to provide food for the family and also cater for other household expenses? Definitely no! Something had to be done.

An idea came into my mind. The disappearance of rain had paved the way for strong winds. What if we could harness the power of the wind and use it to pump water? "It would work," I thought aloud. We used a few of the iron sheets which remained after constructing our main house and used them to form blades. A motor from my father's old motorcycle was used to attach the blades and also run a small pump Dad had been given by one of his clients. The idea worked! An

impossibility became a possibility. We had enough food that summer!

The rains finally came after a while and rendered our makeshift structure useless, the strong winds broke it into pieces, but the menace remained. Climate change is here with us! The weather patterns will change, and we need something permanent and automated. That is what inspired my dream to study computer science, to develop a machine system that can irrigate farms while considering the river water regime and volume of water discharge to prevent overirrigation of the rivers. This will help sustain food production all year round to benefit families like mine, which depend entirely on crop farming.

Community disruption

March 18, 2020, was a dark day! As the President gave the state of the nation address due to the effects of the COVID-19 Pandemic, I prayed the schools would not be closed indefinitely. Against my wishes, the President gave the verdict and ordered the closure of all schools. I was scheduled to attend a mathletes' math contest the following weekend, but it had to be canceled. The decision to close schools hurt me. However, I went home hoping for the best after we returned to school.

At home, I did my best in my studies while struggling to up my standards; keeping in mind the inadequacy of materials at home, this was hard, but I gave it my best shot. As time passed, I decided to explore my social life every day after my studies. Before Covid, I had very few friends, and I would stay at home most of the time. However, after Covid, I became more social and started feeling the power in platonic relationships, which changed who I was. My study work became more manageable; my performance improved after Covid! I always got time to say hi to friends, play light games, and get involved in community work.

Covid 19 was, therefore, a blessing in disguise for me. Hardships such as inflation were there, but I never looked at the opposing side. The change in my social life and the improvement in my academics were the best things that happened to me during this period.

Additional information

2nd June 2021 was the day of school closure for half term break. I boarded the first matatu that came by. Eager to get home on time. The ride from Kakamega where my school is located; to Bungoma (home) was unnecessarily long due to road construction.

We eventually arrived at Bungoma town three hours later, ready to take a motorcycle that would take me home. I eventually got one; a middle-aged man. We talked for a while at first, but as we went by, we stopped talking. My mind wandered far; I was exploring the world! I saw myself in a college abroad where my dreams and my parents' dreams would come true; I did not realize how fast we were moving. The next thing I saw was flashes. And I blacked out. At first, thought I was

dreaming until I slowly started regaining consciousness. I was held by a stranger helping me enter a nearby health center. An accident had occurred!!!

I was placed on a patient bed in the hospital's emergency wing and given first aid. I was severely hurt, but I could talk. They contacted my parents using the information I gave, and they arrived a while later. I had bruises all over my face and knees, but, thank God, there were no fractures. The most injured part was my teeth. My condition had stabilized, and I requested a transfer to a public hospital for dental treatment. The dental clinic was getting closed when we arrived. The doctor present suggested an X-ray, and after seeing the results, advised me to go back the following day to have my middle upper tooth removed as it had been damaged beyond repair.

The next day I went back, and the tooth was removed. From then on, things did change. I had to prolong my stay at home to get well before returning to school. After two weeks, though not wholly healed, I had to return to school. At school, I took my medication well; the bruises healed. But I started having sharp pain in my teeth whenever I took anything cold or hot until it became unbearable. I had to go back home to seek medical attention. On seeing the dentist (another one now), he said a root canal for four teeth was mandatory.

The problem now was how to pay up for the root canal. My parents' only money then was meant to pay school fees for my younger brother, as my father had been retrenched way back. My mother's meagre earnings from tailoring were used to foot bills at home and buy food. For my well-being, they had to pay up anyway. The procedure was done, and I got well.

I had lost one school month looking for proper medication, and I was way behind when I returned to school. I had a lot to catch up on. By the end of the term, everything was back to normal. I could now eat comfortably with very little pain. However, by the beginning of term 2, I developed chest complications. I did not seek proper medical care, though, due to the fear that my parents would not afford it. I've sought medical attention for it ever since, using the student medical scheme, but I've never found a cure. The chest complications barred me from participating in co-curricular activities. I am passionate about football and handball but could not play due to chest complications. That meant I only had to concentrate on classwork, with very little physical activity. However, I am getting well and will return to the field soon!

In September, we lost our one-month-old last-born daughter. The pain was traumatizing and unbearable, but I finally got over it. Everything in my last academic year seemed to go against me, but I still managed to become the 7th-best student nationwide in KCSE!!

Education progression

Details

Education progression details Did or will take gap year

Required explanation

Education progression

In the Kenyan academic system, students typically take a gap year after the national examination. During this period, I was selected to join the Equity Leaders Program. A program run by Equity Group Foundation which picked the top performers nationally and offered job opportunities after a two-week induction. During the induction, I met many equally intelligent people who became my best friends; the best thing that happened to me during the gap year.

After the induction at sports view hotel Kasarani, I got posted to Busia Branch, where I worked as an accounts opening and carding officer. There I utilized my time really well. The happiness that came with serving a customer and seeing them walk away happy was my greatest delight; service to humanity has always run in my blood.

I also had the opportunity to live alone, away from my family. I learnt to be an excellent financial manager because I footed all the bills and faced the reality of the harsh economic times my parents face due to the effects of inflation. I was also responsible for all house chores, which meant I had to do my best in timekeeping. I also improved my cooking skills as I tried new recipes once in a while.

I also got paid for the three months I worked, but I used the money for cardiological tests and helping my parents pay school fees for my two brothers; unluckily, I had no savings.

Harvard University questions

General

Preferred start term	Fall 2023
Admission plan	Restrictive Early Action
Preferred residence	On Campus
Financial aid	Yes
Do you intend to submit supplementary materials?	No
Consider testing?	I would like my application considered without SAT or ACT scores

Academics

What academic program at Harvard interests you?	Computer Science
Specific field(s) of study	Computer Science, Electrical Engineering, Economics
On a scale of 1 (absolutely certain) to 5 (very likely to change), how definite do you consider your academic plans to be?	1
On a scale of 1 (absolutely certain) to 5 (very likely to change), how definite do you consider your vocational plans to be?	2
On a scale of 1 (absolutely certain) to 5 (very likely to change), how definite are your extracurricular and/or athletic interests?	2
Are you applying for the dual degree program with the New England Conservatory?	No

Are you applying for the dual degree program with Berklee College of Music?

No

Online Coursework

No

Additional Intellectual Experiences

During the Covid 19 period, our farming practices were affected by the inconsistency in rainfall and mild flooding, which caused the clogging of lines to the farm. I helped my family by creating a temporary homemade water pump. We flattened a few old iron sheets and changed their shape to form blades. Using 6-inch nails, I drilled holes on one end of the flattened sheets and, using bolts, fixed the blades to an iron ring which was then set to an old motorcycle motor from my father's old motorcycle. The motor rotated the small pump, which initially required a workforce to pump. This project saved our products for that year but was rendered useless after the rains returned.

However, I want to work on something better and permanent that can be used all year round through computerization and the use of more advanced equipment.

Activities

Activity 1	Football
Intended level of participation (sports)	Club/Intramural/Recreational
Activity 2	Basketball
Intended level of participation (sports)	Club/Intramural/Recreational
Activity 3	Environmental Groups
Activity 4	Community Service
Activity 5	Religious Groups
EC Essay	

Soccer has always been my favorite sport. I participated in interclass competitions and played for Form 1 W during my first year in high school. Because I had the best critical thinking abilities on our team, I was always the preferred defender, almost indispensable. I always ensured our team didn't suffer losses. The team was saved by my ability to decipher the striker's thoughts on the opposing team and predict their next move!

My love for football never faded, even after I was hurt in an accident. My teammates were

already giving up hope due to my absence. But I would consistently show up for practice and offer my expert advice.

We won the interclass championship for the third time in a row. In addition, the honor of the best assistant coach of the year was given to me. The success of my team could be attributed to my optimism

Contacts

Have you previously applied to Harvard?	No
How have you learned about Harvard?	Social Media
Additional contact	Website
Additional contact	College Counselor / Teacher
Contact Consent	Yes, I consent to be contacted by Harvard University at the mobile phone number provided below.
Phone Number	+254.0718345781

Family

Parent different address	No
Is parent 1 living?	Yes
Parent 1 Birth Country	Kenya
Parent 1 Occupation	Other
Parent 1 Employment status	Unemployed
Is parent 2 living?	Yes
Parent 2 Birth Country	Kenya
Parent 2 Occupation	Other
Parent 2 Employment status	Self-Employed
Number of siblings	2
Sibling 1 Education level	Graduated from high/secondary school (or equivalent)
Sibling 2 Education level	Some high/secondary school

Other Information

Please list the cities, states and countries where you have lived, with years of residence.

i have lived in Kenya all my life. I have lived in Bungoma, Busia and Nairobi.

Additional location and date if applicable

Bungoma from 2009 to date, Busia for 3 months from June to August 2022, Nairobi from September 2022.

Writing

Have you ever been found responsible for a disciplinary violation at any educational institution?

No

Have you ever been convicted of, or pled guilty or no contest to, any felony or misdemeanor?

No

Students Applying From Outside

Applying from outside US/Canada

Yes

If interviews are available in your area have you had or have you scheduled an admissions interview?

No, there are not interviews available where I live.

What specific plan do you have, if any, for using the education you hope to receive?

I want to pursue Computer Science. If it is made possible at Harvard, I will develop a system to ensure a continuous water supply to our farms for maximum crop production. The system would also check on the river volume, maintaining its regime. This would help combat hunger.

U.S. Military Veterans

U.S. Armed Forces

No

Affirmations

By submitting this application, I affirm my understanding of and agreement to the statements found here: <http://www.commonapp.org/affirmations>.